

Leading People Through Change

Chapter 4 — Leadership Styles & Competencies

Presented by:

Bibek Ropakheti

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will be able to:

- **Distinguish** between the roles of "Management" and "Leadership" in change.
- **Analyze** the relevance of Transformational Leadership in sustaining change.
- **Evaluate** the concept of Distributed Leadership (moving beyond the "Hero" leader).
- **Understand** the importance of Authentic Leadership and trust.
- **Identify** the core competencies required for effective change leadership.

Management vs. Leadership

While often used interchangeably, they serve different functions during change.

Management (Transaction)

- Focus: Complexity and Order.
- Planning and Budgeting.
- Organizing and Staffing.
- Controlling and Problem Solving.
- *Goal: Stability Efficiency.*

Leadership (Transformation)

- Focus: Change and Movement.
- Establishing Direction (Vision).
- Aligning People.
- Motivating and Inspiring.
- *Goal: Adaptive Change.*

Leadership Styles in Change

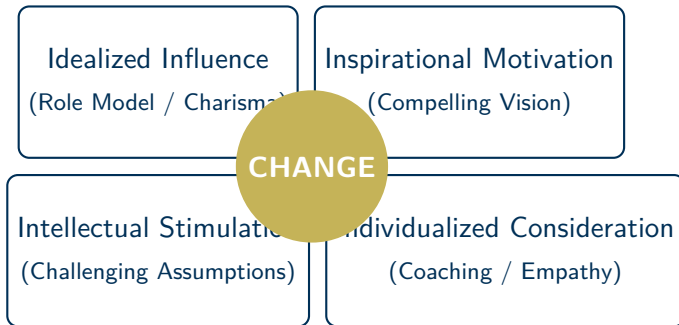
Different contexts require different approaches.

1. **Transformational Leadership:** Creating a vision and inspiring people to achieve it.
2. **Transactional Leadership:** Using rewards/punishments to ensure compliance (Exchange based).
3. **Distributed Leadership:** Sharing leadership responsibilities across the organization.
4. **Authentic Leadership:** Building legitimacy through honest relationships.

Hodges argues that sustainable change requires moving beyond purely Transactional methods.

Transformational Leadership Components

Based on Bass Avolio's "4 Is".



Transformational leaders engage the **emotions** and **values** of employees, not just their transactional needs.

The Myth of the Hero Leader

The idea that one charismatic individual at the top drives all change is outdated and dangerous. It creates dependency and bottlenecks.

Distributed Leadership means:

- Leadership is a **practice**, not a position.
- Change agents exist at all levels (middle managers, frontline staff).
- Responsibility for sustaining change is shared.

Authentic Leadership

In an era of skepticism, "Authenticity" is the foundation of trust.

Core Characteristics:

- **Self-Awareness:** Knowing one's own strengths, weaknesses, and values.
- **Relational Transparency:** Being open and honest; not "faking it."
- **Balanced Processing:** Objectively analyzing data before making decisions.
- **Internalized Moral Perspective:** Guided by internal moral standards, not outside pressure.

Impact

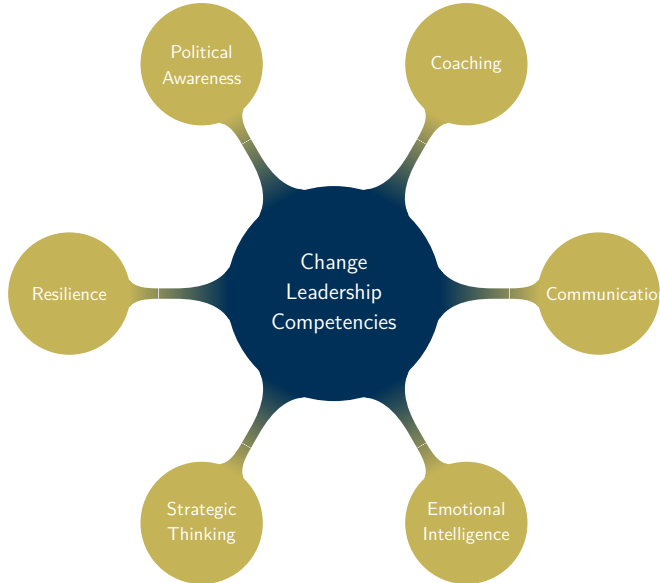
Authentic leaders create "Psychological Safety," allowing employees to take the risks necessary for change.

The Role of the Change Leader

What does a change leader actually *do*?

1. **Sense-making:** Interpreting the external environment and explaining "Why change?" to the team.
2. **Visioning:** Painting a picture of the future that is desirable and feasible.
3. **Aligning:** Ensuring structures, systems, and culture support the new direction.
4. **Empowering:** Removing obstacles so others can act.

Competencies for Leading Change



Leading Through the Emotional Cycle

Leaders must adapt their style as employees move through the "Change Curve."

Employee Stage	Typical Emotion	Leadership Action
1. Shock/Denial Reassurance	Fear, Numbness	Communicate: Facts
2. Resistance Support (Don't fight)	Anger, Frustration	Listen: Empathy
3. Exploration Short-term goals	Confusion, Curiosity	Direct: Training
4. Commitment	Hope, Relief	Celebrate: Reward success

Challenges for Leaders

Leading change is exhausting and difficult.

- **Change Fatigue:** Leaders often burn out from constant resistance.
- **Isolation:** Being the "face" of unpopular decisions.
- **The "Air Sandwich":** Senior leaders have vision, frontline has reality; Middle Managers get crushed in between.

Self-Care

Leaders must maintain their own resilience to effectively lead others. You cannot pour from an empty cup.

Summary:

1. Sustainable change requires **Leadership**, not just Management.
2. **Transformational** and **Authentic** leadership styles build the trust required for change.
3. Move away from the "Hero Leader" to **Distributed Leadership**.
4. Leaders must match their behavior to the emotional needs of their team (The Change Curve).

Thank You

Questions?